

- 経済学領域における人間と社会の課題

Human and social issues in the area of economics.

- 26 June 2024.

- ZHANG JING

- Agenda



Self introduction

What I would like to tell you as a former international student



Reflections on my postgraduate years

Motivations for moving from master's to PhD



How to carry out research (from a management and marketing perspective)

Establishing a research theme

Review of previous research



Research

- Reconstructing marketing theory by rethinking the relationship between firms and customers

- Research keywords.

service, interaction, value co-creation, service logic



Representative papers

- Zhang(2024) "Clarifying Experience Formation from the Customer's Perspective

Using Critical Incident Technique," *Journal of Serviceology*, Vol.9, No.1, pp.1-8.

- 張・梁(2023) COVID-19環境下におけるサービス経験の感情的要因 感情種類による影響の探索的・実証的研究 □¥, マーケティングレビュー, 第4巻第1号, 51-58頁。

Able to present the most recent paper as their representative paper

Conscious of keeping a paper under peer review at all times

- Reflections on my postgraduate years



Why I studied abroad

- In my undergraduate years, I had the chance to study abroad because...
Specialization in linguistics, wanting to improve my Japanese.
⇒Studied language under a teacher who was a simultaneous interpreter for the former Prime Minister of Japan

- **Why study in Japan after graduating from university**

Experience of studying abroad as an exchange student

Due to the Lehman Brothers collapse, employment in China was not optimistic

There was a quota of recommendations for graduate school due to the partnership with a Japanese university.

(At the time, it was rare for students from China to take the Japanese postgraduate entrance examinations directly from China)

Tried other specializations using language rather than Japanese (linguistics, culture)

(Among the many graduate schools of the partner university, I chose the Graduate School of Business Administration)



Two years of the Master's program

- There was a lot of interaction with fellow students in the Graduate School.

- I spent a year in the International Student House and had many exchanges with international students from other countries.
- In second year, when putting together master's thesis, "research could be interesting" + supervisor's recommendation => [Entering the second semester of doctoral studies = path to researcher].
- Entrance examinations for the second semester of doctoral programmes at national universities (mainly considering universities that offer autumn admission).

Translated with www.DeepL.com/Translator (free version)



PhD program (4.5 years)

- Almost zero people obtain a degree in three years (the situation differs from university to university), as clearing the dissertation submission eligibility assessment is a prerequisite.
- On the other hand, the achievements in thesis and academic activities during postgraduate years give an advantage in terms of employment.



How to carry out the research



Structure of the thesis (in the field of business administration and marketing)

- Establishment of research theme

Research background ⇒ Problem awareness ⇒ Research objectives

- Review of previous research

What research results have been obtained so far on the research topic?

How is your research positioned within the field?

Are there limitations to previous research? Overcoming the limitations is the originality of one's research!



Further refinement of the research question (research questions into RQs)

What exactly do we seek to uncover?

- Research methodology

Research methods to clarify the research question (RQ)

- Collecting and analysing data

Secondary data (e.g. existing data), primary data (surveys)

- Discussion and conclusions

Logical discussion linking the results of data analysis to the findings of previous research

Clarification of answers to research questions and RQs



Establishing a research topic

- Area of interest $\Rightarrow$ Empirical events

- Survey of basic material

- Selective review of previous research

(search and see what papers/materials come up)

- Think about the story with the information and knowledge that has been accumulated.

(background + awareness of the problem/research gap + objectives) $\Rightarrow$ Chapter 1 of the research paper

? Why did you choose this theme?



Setting a research topic

- As a supervisor, ask your postgraduate students

☐ What is your research gap (problem awareness)?

☐ Why do you need to research this topic?

☐ Is there an answer in previous research on this topic?

× x Because 'I' am interested $\Rightarrow$ Your interest is not important.

× x Because no one else has researched it ⇒ Insufficient study of previous research.

□ Good research topic/project (type A)
= (1) original, (2) important and (3) interesting

□ To find a research topic/project

- Concepts and structures that are taken for granted but not systematically considered
- Look for assumptions that are usually taken for granted but not applied to all situations
- Look for processes that are ignored or not fully understood

□ Establishing a research theme (Storrie)

- Empirical events

Recently, a new consumption trend and marketing act called 00 has attracted a lot of attention.

This new phenomenon has unique characteristics compared to previous phenomena, such as Δ

Objective data, such as commercial statistics, are presented to show the practical importance of this phenomenon.

⇒ This research topic is required by industry and society

- Existing research

What has been the scope and focus of academic examination of this phenomenon?

(Not just my interest, there are others in academia with the same interest)

⇒ That this research topic is also required by academia

Demonstrate the difference between the consideration of existing research and the focus of your own research.

⇒ Uniqueness of the research (originality)



Previous research review

The literature review has methods.

- Narrative review

□ A method whereby researchers select, evaluate and interpret relevant literature based on their own knowledge and experience.

- Systematic review

□ A method of objectively evaluating existing research and comprehensively organising the literature.

See the forest for the trees (when your knowledge and experience is limited...)

- On what basis has the research topic/issue been discussed in the relevant field?

□ What have we learned from existing research and what is still unknown?

⇒ Clarification of research gaps.

□ Organise the position of your research theme/issue in the relevant field.

Example of a method.

- Collect article data from online databases (Google Scholar, Scopus, Science direct, Web of Science, J-stage, etc.)

- Use tools (HistCite, CiteSpace) for citation and co-citation analysis

- Finding highly influential articles on the research topic/problem (identification of highly cited articles).

- Make a list of references and start with the highly cited papers for close reading.

[Recommended] Start with a systematic review paper of the research topic/issue.



Results of previous research reviews

- What solutions and results have been obtained so far to elucidate the research theme (issue)?
- Do these research results provide sufficient knowledge to elucidate the research topic?
- What are the limitations of previous research in elucidating the research topic?
- How can the limitations be overcome?